If the set of string exceeds cache size, *burstsort* becomes considerably faster than any other string sorting algorithms.

6.4.4 T9

T9 was such a big milestone in mobile history that we still (mistakenly) address new mobiles' spell checkers as T9 - though it was abandoned long ago, with the advent of smartphones.

The name comes as an abbreviation of "Text on 9 keys", as the alphabet was (long before mobile phones) divided into groups of 3 to 4 characters that would fit into a digital phone numpad.

In the original design for landline phones, every number had to be pressed 1 to 4 times to choose every single letter: for instance, 2 had to be pressed once for `'a'`, twice for `'b'` and thrice for `'c'`.

With T9, instead, the idea was that the user would press each key once for each letter in the word, to state that the `i`-th letter belonged to the group of the `k`-th button. Then T9 would offer suggestions for possible words made out of those combinations of letters, or even directly provide the right word, if only 1 possible match was found.

For instance, typing 2-6-3 would select all three letters combinations form the cartesian product `[a,b,c]x[m,n,o]x[d,e,f]`, and T9 would provide valid English words like `[and, cod, con,...]`.